ROOTEDWITHKHETHIWE

School of the Prophets

FOUNDATIONS



LESSON 03 / 05

Daniel the Interpreter

Search a matter with humility

SCRIPTURE / TEACHING / PRACTICE

Daniel the Interpreter

READ IN WEB • Daniel 2:14–30 · Daniel 7:15–16, 28 · Genesis 40:5–8

Daniel’s first move

In Daniel 2, the king’s demand puts lives at risk. Daniel asks for time, goes to his companions and invites them to seek mercy from God. When the mystery is disclosed, he blesses God before returning to the king. Trace his actions in order. Ask what changes when you read the scene as a story of dependence and shared prayer. Daniel’s answer before the king directs attention to the God who reveals mysteries.

Receiving and understanding

Daniel 7 shows Daniel disturbed by his own vision and asking what it means. By the end he keeps the matter in his heart. Compare him with Joseph in Genesis 40:8, who also directs attention to God when asked about interpretation. These passages give us room to record a dream, acknowledge that it affected us, ask for understanding and leave questions open.

Read the whole dream first

Record the setting, people, action, emotional shifts and ending before circling individual images. Ask what the dreamer associates with an image and what is happening in her life. A locked gate at a childhood home may evoke something different from a locked gate at work. A possible reading should help explain the sequence and tone. Keep a separate note for recent experiences that might have supplied the dream’s imagery.

Practice and reflection

Practice · The envelope at the station

A woman dreams she is at a station with a sealed envelope. She tries to run toward a train, but her sister tells her to look at the ticket. The train on the ticket leaves an hour later. She sits down and feels relieved. The woman has recently been rushing to submit several applications.

Observation. Write what happens without explaining it. Where does the feeling change? What detail corrects her first assumption? **Possible interpretation.** The dream could reflect pressure to hurry or invite reflection on timing. The recent applications also give the scene an ordinary source of imagery. **Response.** She could check her real deadlines and bring her anxiety to prayer. The dream itself gives her no basis to miss a real deadline.

Practise humility with someone else’s story

Ask permission before sharing someone’s dream. Let the dreamer describe what felt important to her. Offer a possible reading as a possibility, then give her space to disagree. If an interpretation would pressure someone into a consequential decision, pause, weigh it with trusted counsel and respect their freedom to decide.

Journal and pray

What do I know from the dream itself? What have I added from my own associations? What question would help me understand the dream more carefully?

God of wisdom, help me listen carefully and speak humbly. Give me patience with mystery and compassion for the person whose story I am hearing. Amen.

SOURCE • The Interpreter, “There Is a God in Heaven,” “Prayer Before Presumption” and “Ask for Understanding.”